



BEFORE

Victory in the American Revolution did not settle the new republic's borders. It remained surrounded by the colonial territories of Britain, France, and Spain.

THE LOUISIANA PURCHASE

In 1803, France struggled to suppress enslaved people's **war for freedom in Haiti**. When Thomas Jefferson sought to purchase New Orleans and access to the Mississippi River from France, Emperor Napoleon I, frustrated by French failure in Haiti, offered him the entire Louisiana territory for \$15 million. The **Louisiana Purchase** nearly doubled the size of the U.S. overnight.

EXPANSION TO THE WEST



A COMPASS FROM THE LEWIS AND CLARK EXPEDITION

Jefferson announced the purchase on July 4, 1803, and the very next day the 28-year-old Army Captain **Meriwether Lewis**, a personal friend and aide to the president, set out from Washington to begin his and **William Clark's exploration of the West**. Their epic journey, which lasted until September 1806, revealed a vast expanse of territory inhabited by Indigenous peoples, and ripe for **settlement by future generations of Americans**.

In 1800, most Americans still farmed, and lived in small communities poorly connected by rough roads. When Thomas Jefferson entered the White House in March 1801, the nation had around 5.3 million people living between the Atlantic seaboard and